

Empathy Map Canvas

IDEATION PHASE — EMPATHIZE & DISCOVER

Date of Submission	02 July 2026	Team ID	SWTID-2026-4978
Project Name	Strategic Product Placement Analysis	Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Operational Empathy Mapping

An empathy map serves as an analytical visual framework to better interpret a core user's behaviors, challenges, and operational constraints. In the context of our retail layout mapping project, this framework isolates the exact friction points and targeted goals experienced by a retail manager moving from qualitative routines into an empirical, data-driven methodology.

What does he THINK and FEEL?

- Worries whether premium layout spots (like end-caps) genuinely justify higher operational setup costs for all products.
- Wants to replace legacy guesswork with concrete empirical data metrics to optimize visual shelf space.
- Aspires to stabilize dynamic store turnover volumes and optimize localized pricing models.

What does he SEE?

- Sees customers frequently bypass standard central aisles entirely to crowd around quick convenience display points.
- Sees competitors aggressively shift high-volume trends directly onto premium storefront end-caps to grab foot traffic.
- Sees row-level transaction spreadsheets (Product Positioning.csv) that are too massive to quickly summarize without visual dashboards.

What does he HEAR?

- Hears from logistics personnel that highly promoted inventory in lower-traffic configurations continues to stay completely stagnant.
- Hears from executive leadership demanding visual data-driven validation frameworks before

What does he SAY and DO?

- **Says:** "We require a centralized dashboard matrix where interacting with one customer type maps out their optimal department shelf location."

signing off on full brick-and-mortar modifications.

- **Does:** Feeds flat datasets into Tableau engines, sets up 8 detailed workspaces, and links cross-sheet animation filters.

PAIN (Obstacles & Challenges)

Difficulty isolating whether an active transaction surge is driven entirely by a marketing campaign or by native store geometry placement. Managing unorganized cross-metric links across foot traffic counts, item price tiers, and competitive marketplace pricing presents significant friction.

GAIN (Wishes & Measures of Success)

A synchronized 8-sheet operational workspace running flawlessly on dynamic dashboard actions. Clear floor allocation roadmaps mapping specific inventory divisions explicitly against target consumer demographic types (e.g., Families, College Students).